

SCOPE OF WORK

1. Executive summary

Sri Lanka Telecom (SLT), the leading telecom provider in Sri Lanka, seeks a comprehensive bill printing solution for all customer bills from January 1, 2027. SLT generates bills centrally under four cycles and outsources formatting, printing, enveloping, and sorting. Printed bills are delivered via postal services or designated channels, while e-bills are transferred digitally. SLT aims to enhance customer experience by adopting advanced technologies, including multilingual printing and detailed itemization.

2. Project Duration

Sri Lanka Telecom (SLT) seeks an efficient, flexible bill formatting and printing solution for its total volumes with comprehensive bill printing solution for its consolidated volumes commencing from 01st January 2027.

3.1 Introduction

Sri Lanka Telecom (SLT) expects to format & print whole SLT customer bills in each month for all its products and services.

Entire SLT bills are generated centrally at SLT Head Office, Colombo 01 under multiple bill cycles. All bill files generated are currently sent to an external print vender for formatting, printing, enveloping and sorting according to the postal codes and bill handling codes.

Said sorted, enveloped bills are to be handed over to Postal Department or any other pre-defined destination for timely bill delivery/posting. Part of the bills shall be delivered to a pre-defined Delivery office/delivery channels/locations and in case of e bills, soft file transfer to a defined location and/or customer requested via data link.

Currently SLT has four bill cycles. Advertisements and the other optional requirements in each bill cycles are communicated to the print vender in a regular manner.

SLT would like to introduce latest technologies and features available in the Telco bill printing industry in SLT customer bills including multilingual bill printing, itemization for efficiency and

better customer experience.

3.2 Proposed System

Sri Lanka Telecom (SLT) is planning to go for a more efficient and flexible bill formatting, printing and enveloping solution for its total volumes

- i. Currently SLT has four bill cycles as 1st, 8th, 16th, 24th where majority of bills are processed in month end bill cycle and mid-month.
- ii. In addition to above bill cycles, there will be smaller number of bills processed on any time of the day, day of the week, which are excluded from above bill runs and processed separately due to technical reasons.
- iii. SLT may introduce more bill cycles as and when required with its' business requirements and better customer service.
- iv. SLT bill processing can be done at any hour of the day and the day of week and will be delivered to the external vender at the same basis. External vender to take over and deliver the formatted and printed bills as per the agreed SLA accordingly.
- v. SLT need to get printed their daily/monthly processed bill files in a more manageable manner and hand over to postal Department/ pre- defined courier service for timely bill posting.
- vi. SLT needs to get formatted PDF in daily/monthly processed bill files in a more manageable manner and transferred to pre-defined location for timely bill delivery.
- vii. SLT need flexibility on different bill formats/ multi-color advertisements / color images and message printing flexibility for each bill cycle/ each month for selected sets of accounts.
- viii. SLT need personalized bill messages, formatting and printing on special set of customers defined in SLT bill files. SLT needs to monitor, reconcile and manage all over all printing process through an online web-based system including online management reports.
- ix. SLT would like to improve the quality and customer experience of SLT bills in future and shall expand the existing process with advanced features like Multi language bill printing, personalized bill printing etc. with no disturbance to existing regular billing process. Hence, the proposed system shall be scalable and technically feasible for future improvements in industry.

4 SYSTEM SPECIFICATION

4.1 System Overview

In each month, each bill cycle wise, the proposed system shall format the Sri Lanka Telecom customer bills in to given bill styles, pre-print or data print the given advertisements, print the formatted data in each bill, sort as per postal codes and envelope all the bills of in high quality and hand over these bills for postage/ courier service within Specified SLA requirements. If there are insertions of separate leaflets for selected bills it has to be arranged accordingly.

Above entire process has to be done in a more economical way to SLT by using all possible techniques including enveloping all possible bills as single page bills with no separate enveloping effort and cost.

4.2 Both pre-printing of forms (hard copy & soft copy), envelopes and data printing to be done 24 hrs. per day and 7 days per week basis.

4.2.1 The system should be capable of handling both single page bills and multi- page bills in both hard copy and soft forms. And all bills shall be separated as per the given Bill style & bill Handling codes which are given as “flags” in Bill Data files.

Currently, following major bill handling codes are maintained.

BILL_HANDLING_CODE	BILL_HANDLING_CODE_NAME
01	Hard Copy
02	E-statement by email
24	E-Statement by SMS

And all the currently defined bill handling codes are mentioned in technical tag mapping documents.

Note: New bill handling codes will be introduced from time to time to cater new business requirements and will be communicated in advance.

4.2.1.1

- a) System should be capable of printing both single side and double side data printing
- b) Duplex Printing

4.2.1.2 Printing redundancy machines availability and arrangements

- 4.2.1.3 Pre-printed papers should be used as per the bill formats, Multi color bill advertisements/ color images or bill messages required in each bill cycle or bill month. And given advertisements should be able to print selectively for SLT given accounts/invoices - in each bill run.

Quality techniques shall be used in single page bill enveloping and payment slip separation as applicable in each bill.

- 4.2.2 Single page bills should be enveloped in a more economical manner with no additional envelop cost.

- 4.2.2.1

- a) Appropriate latest automatic technology shall be used to seal/envelope the single page bills at high-speed rate which should not be less than 25,000 bills per hour.
 - b) Availability of suitable redundancy arrangements for production machines

- 4.2.2.2 Single page bill enveloped shall be properly sealed

- 4.2.2.3 Possible technology to be used to format maximum number of bills as “Single page” bills and arrange immediate printing.

- 4.2.3 Multipage bills should be delivered in a separate envelope with pre- printed given advertisements in each month.

- 4.2.3.1

- a) Appropriate technology should be used to envelop the multi-page bills at high-speed rate which is not less than 15,000 bills per hour.
 - b) Total machine capacity to meet SLA

- 4.2.4 The system should be equipped with automatic sorting, sealing and enveloping to handle multipage bills.

- 4.2.4.1 System should be able to insert a separate leaflet or messages carrying paper before enveloping some selected/separated bills

- 4.2.4.2 If manual insertion of bills is proposed, availability of adequate number of trained staff to be assured.

- 4.2.5 System should use high speed state of art Laser printing Technology for all types of bills.
- 4.2.6 Printing papers should be of superior quality and be suitable for the purpose of Laser Printing and high-speed sealing and sorting.
- 4.2.6.1 All printing papers used for single page bills shall be in size A4, for enabling easy filing and document management purposes.
 - 4.2.6.2 Good quality paper perforation shall be done on single page enveloped bills
 - 4.2.6.3 All printing papers used for multi-page bills shall be in A4 size, for enabling easy filing and document management purposes
- 4.2.7 Printing Customer Name and Address in the bills for self-envelopment.
- 4.2.7.1 For Multi page bills - Customers' name and address shall be printed in a manner that they are clearly shown through the window of a sealed envelope.
 - 4.2.7.2 For single page bills -Customers Name and Address to be printed such as to use the same single paper enveloped (fully sealed) bill for postage.
- 4.2.8 System shall use high speed state of the art Technology for generating soft copy bills
Appropriate latest automatic technology shall be used to format E-bills at high-speed rate which should not be less than 50,000 bills per hour.
- 4.2.9 The Tenderer shall not modify the contents of the data provided by SLT.
- 4.2.9.1 If SLT is authorized and formally requested to do any data enrichment for accurate bill presentation, vender shall be able to do so with all necessary validations and verification process in place.
 - 4.2.9.2
 - a) Tenderer shall validate regular invoice totals & report totals in bulk, before initiating production printing process in each bill cycle.
 - b) Capability to issue monthly bill cycle wise invoices with supportive documents to verify the same.
 - c) Tenderer should indicate the physical count in each respective delivery note as supporting document
 - d) The count indicated in delivery note will be reconciled with invoice count for payments

- 4.2.10 The Tenderer shall ensure the confidentiality of the data in transit among SLT premises and Tenderer premises including DR sites used.
- 4.2.11 All SLT data provided to the Tenderer should be restricted to only those who are authorized to handle the data.
All possible data/ information security and physical security measures to be taken at the Tenderer's premises for SLT given original and processed data.
- 4.2.12 The Tenderer shall propose an online web-based solution for recording, reconciling and reporting for incident management of following:
- 4.2.12.1 The number of bills printed (both hard & soft forms), enveloped and made ready for postage by the Tenderer versus the number of bills contained in the SLT data files/ batches per bill cycles provided by SLT at any given day / time - to monitor the progress of bill printing at a given time through an online facility
 - 4.2.12.2 Visibility to monitor damaged /delayed/failed to re-print bills against each bill files/ batches per bill cycles provided by SLT
 - 4.2.12.3 Physical count of Detailed and Summary reports should be made available online and with invoice to SLT. i.e. Number of envelopes used under each category, number of bills/ papers / envelopes used under each color options / advertisement options etc..) – to verify the cost incurred for bill printing in each bill cycle/each month by SLT
- 4.2.13 The Tenderer shall propose a method to detect failures/errors in the processes of formatting and printing or enveloping and provision should be there to correct those before the bills go for postage or to relevant delivery location.
- 4.2.14 All damaged bills if any shall be detected re-printed and replaced during the processes of printing and enveloping.
- 4.2.15 All corrupt bills, if any, shall be detected, re-generated and replaced during the processes of file generation

4.2.16 The formatting and printing software shall be capable of ensuring data quality by validating, correcting, calculating etc. at the time of formatting. And it should be flexible on formatting the bills as per any given bill template or design within an expected time period by SLT as per the incident severity.

Hence latest versions of international standard software used in the Telco Bill Formatting and Printing Industry has to be used.

4.2.17 The printing software shall be capable to include Bar codes in the bill prints.

The Bar code shall be inclusive of Account number/ invoice number. However, the exact contents of the bar code and the SLT using Bar code reader details shall be confirmed at the time of tender negotiation.

The printing software should be capable of including QR code in the bill prints.

4.2.18 Once the multilingual bill printing is tested and in place, the printing software shall be capable to locate the language code send in the SLT data files and arrange the automated data printing according to the language defined in each customer account.

4.2.19 System should be capable of using any color options for advertisements and the images required to print on bills and Envelopes (Timely pre-printed and ready to do data printing) in each bill cycle / selected bills by SLT.

4.2.20 Currently used Sample bill formats and the sample data files from SLT will be made available to the Tenderer at the time of testing and has to be formatted in full volumes.

4.2.20.1 Given SLT full volume of data to formatted, sorted as per the postal codes and automatically separated into given bill styles and bill handling codes at the time of testing

4.2.20.2 Bill printing of the same shall be limited to SLT agreed selected bulk samples with selected scenarios.

4.2.21 Bill format changes, minor tag mapping level changes required if any will be informed with sample data files whenever required by SLT and the test bills should be made available to SLT team immediately/within one day /two days of time period depending on the change. There shall not be a separate charge for such regular minor changes. Major changes if any will be made in advance and such CR requests will be managed separately.

- 4.2.21.1 There should not be any ambiguity between the testing programs and the production programs which are maintained separately with proper version control and Documentation at vender site.
- 4.2.21.2 Said newly introduced and tested formats or changes to existing formats to be incorporated in bulk bill printing programs without disturbing ongoing production printing process and agreed SLA with SLT.
- 4.2.22 Color advertisements should be able to print selectively both SLT single page bill itself use as envelopes and multi-page bill with separate envelopes.
- 4.2.23 Flexibility of using multiple Artworks with multi color advertisements in each month each bill cycle shall be possible. (Varying from 02 - 08 numbers per bill cycle)
- 4.2.24 The vendor shall propose their quality assurance plan at the invoice formatting, printing, sorting, insertion and enveloping job.
- 4.2.25 The vender shall have disaster recovery plans for the production systems including manpower. And the availability of back up machines to production machines and E Bill related servers and connections to be available in a separate geographical area from main site to cater the SLA requirements in a disaster situation
- 4.2.26 The vendor shall propose their coordination procedure with respect to emergencies or escalation of day-to-day operational incidents.
- 4.2.27 Vender shall propose a method for proper change management procedure.
And vender shall manage proper change control, version control on the main printing program/s after each change applied in production as requested by SLT.
- 4.2.28 System should be capable of printing/envelope SLT requested documents to SLT customers, other than the above Enterprise level bills, but in lesser quantity bands and deliver for postage. Color options and enveloping option requirements will be similar to the bill printing job. (Eg: Credit Action related Letters to Customers)
Prices for these bands shall be quoted separately

- 4.2.29 Facility shall be available to separate the bills based on the Bill Handling Code and deliver the bills as defined by SLT for each Bill Handling code but not limited to as “e-bills” in soft form (PDF) back to SLT
- 4.2.29.1 Technological Capabilities (Hardware and software capability) for E-Bill formatting, licensing and storage to handle multiple pages.
- 4.2.30 Parallel formatting, printing and enveloping of any given SLT bills in multiple formats shall be possible at any time of the day / day of the week
- 4.2.31 Parallel soft bill generation is preferred for different bill handling codes. The size of a soft invoice should be less than 300kB for single paged bills. The bills in the print vendor server should be archived after 03 months, and System availability should be around 99.9%.
- 4.2.32 System availability should be around 99.9%. Separate SFTP users should be created in the print vendor storage server for each bill handling code and access should be given to specific locations. Simultaneous login capability with each user should be allowed. The soft copies should be made available as batches of 1500 invoices in .zip format.
- 4.2.33 The first bill of all new customers shall be delivered as printed format irrespective of the bill handling code. Subsequent bills shall be as per the bill handling code.

5 SPECIAL REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Pricing Guidelines

5.1.1 The Tenderer should provide price information and price schedule based on each month's total volumes: The Tenderer shall provide tax exclusive prices and shall mention the applicable taxes and their respective effective rates separately.

5.1.1.1 Single page bill printing

Charges for single-page bills should be given in following bands as enterprise volumes of SLT. This price should be inclusive of pre-printing, formatting, folding, sealing and handing over to SLT defined dispatching channels including Postal Department, with both side data printing charges.

Band 1: Less than 500,000 Invoices

Band 2: 500,001 - 1,000,000 Invoices

Band 3: 1,000,001 - 1,500,000 Invoices

Band 4: 1,500,001 - 2,000,000 Invoices

Band 5: More than 2,000,000 Invoices

5.1.1.2 Multi page bill printing

This price should be inclusive of pre-printing, formatting, data printing, folding, insertion, sealing and handing over to SLT defined dispatching channels including postal department.

5.1.1.2.1. Unit price for a printed paper (A4 size) for the enterprise volumes of SLT shall be based on following bands

Band 1: Less than 75,000 sheets

Band 2: 75,001 - 150,000 sheets

Band 3: 150,001 - 250,000 sheets

Band 4: 250,001 - 1,000,000 sheets

Band 5: more than 1,000,000 sheets

5.1.1.2.1.1 Unit price for both single side data printing and double side data printing of A4 paper to be given separately for all above bands.

5.1.1.2.2. Unit price for the standard Envelops with given preprinted advertisement for the insertion of A4 size printed multipage bills for the total SLT monthly volumes shall be based on following bands.

a) 9" x 4" envelopes

Band 1: less than 75,000

Band 2: 75,001 - 150,000

Band 3: 150,001 - 250,000

Band 4: 251,001 - 1,000,000

Band 5: more than 1,000,000

b) 9" x 6" envelopes

Band 1: less than 1,000

Band 2: 1001 -2,000

Band 3: 2001 -3,000

Band 4: more than 3,000

c) 12" x 9" envelopes

Band 1: less than 2,000

Band 2: 2001 -3,000

Band 3: 3001 -4,000

Band 4: more than 4,000

5.1.1.3 e-bill and other soft forms bill handling

Unit price for handling e-bills shall be provided separately.

E-bill/ soft copy bill bands (PDF formatted)

Band 1: Less than 500,000 Invoices

Band 2: 500,001 - 750,000 Invoices

Band 3: 750,001 – 1,000,000 Invoices

Band 4: More than 1,000,000 Invoices

5.1.2 Cost Item Independence

Every unit that carries an individual price according to the price decomposition specified in the section 5.1.1 shall explicitly list any dependency to other Cost items.

5.1.3 Pricing on color options for each category of advertisements.

- Single page bills
- A4 Paper used for multi-page bills and
- Envelopes for multi-page bills

If pricing is different for color options of above, it shall be given separately for all enterprise volume bands in above section 5.1.1

5.1.4 Unit Price List

The Tenderer should provide Unit Price List giving individual prices on all Cost Items according to price decomposition specified in section 5.1.1

5.1.5 Any other prices

Any other prices relevant to the Tender shall be included separately.

5.1.6 Pricing of A4 paper / envelopes to be based on the total volumes of SLT bills in each month

5.1.6.1 Pricing for A4 paper shall be quoted with color options and single side and double side data printing prices separately.

5.1.7 Payment of printing job shall be on batches of delivery to relevant delivery channels basis and will be done by SLT according to its bill cycles. And vender shall provide necessary bill counts handed over to relevant delivery channels for the same.

5.1.8 Pricing for all above A4 Paper (used in both single page and multi-page bills) and envelopes should be with paper quality of 80 GSM.

(Similar pricing for any other high-quality papers may be given as additional information.)

5.1.9 Pricing for SLT Bill Printing shall be provided as per the attached “Pricing schedule I”

5.1.10 Separate pricing for any document printing / enveloping other than the Enterprise level bill printing shall be quoted separately as per 4.2.26. Tenderer shall provide pricing for said lesser bands separately.

5.2 Vender Experience and Capabilities

5.2.1 Tenderers Organization

The Tenderer shall provide a description of the organization proposed to execute this project. This description shall include all relevant details such as financial, corporate, personnel, Major areas of business activity, Address of Head office with Telephone, Fax and E-mail for contact person related to this Tender. Address of Office responsible for this Tender.

5.2.2 Tenderer Experience

5.2.2.1 The Tenderer shall have experience in planning, designing, engineering, and developing. Supplying, installation and maintenance of form production equipment in the offset printing industry at least five years in Sri Lanka.

5.2.2.2 The tenderer shall have experience in bulk volumes of data printing with latest formatting software and machinery in the industry.

5.2.3 General Experience of the Tenderer

The Tenderer shall provide information to describe experience which it has had in a similar service indicating its functionality and size. The description shall include references including names of organizations, service types, capacities, functionality and others in existing operational systems supplied by the Tenderer.

5.2.4 Tenderer's Experience on Proposed System

The Tenderer shall provide details of experience of business Form Production System, formatting and data printing using latest printing software in the industry. The description shall include references including names of organizations, Service types. Capacities, functionality, installed/ initiated year and others.

5.2.5 Tenderer shall describe in detail the entire bill formatting, printing, enveloping, dispatching and overall verification process indicating the formatting software, machinery and human resource propose to fulfill SLT monthly bill printing process within given SLA.

Tenderer may explain the same while using process workflows.

5.2.6 Tenderer shall list out all latest Technologies/functionalities and printing capabilities available in Telco bill printing and can be used in proposed SLT bill printing solution.

5.3 Proposed Solution Operational Requirements

- 5.3.1 Proposed production site which is for preprinted form preparation, bill formatting and data printing, shall be in Sri Lanka and at a close proximity to Colombo.
- 5.3.2 Total cost for the connectivity between SLT to proposed Production/DR site shall be borne by the Tenderer.
And only the technical support will be arranged by SLT.
- 5.3.3 Multiple color advertisements required to pre-print in each bill cycle or bill batch will be provided by SLT maximum of 7-10 days prior to each bill cycle. Said advertisements should be carried on each paper / envelope used in said bill cycle data printing. However, the sample artwork produced by the vender will be approved by SLT for each category of advertisement in each cycle.
- 5.3.4 Unformatted bill files of SLT will be transferred daily and the proposed production solution shall be capable to initiate formatting, printing and enveloping the bills at the same time and report the volumes printed/enveloped/delivered separately within agreed Service Levels.
- 5.3.5 The proposed system shall be capable of providing test bills in soft form and printed copies in agreed bill formats with any given test bill files by SLT, at any time of the day, day of the week.
- 5.3.6 SLT authorized operational teams shall be able to attend and supervise the production bill printing process, quality of the bills, accuracy of selected sample bills, delivery of the bills to postal department, at any time of the day, day of a week while formatting, printing or enveloping all major regular bill runs in each month.

5.4 Service Level Agreements (SLA)

- 5.4.1 SLAs are to ensure the operation of the System as required by SLT in terms of the technical specifications and timely printing the Bills in agreed delivery targets with agreed volumes. The Tenderer shall provide service guarantees for their response time.
- 5.4.2 Tenderers are required to include relevant terms for such a Service Level Agreement as part of their tender, with the final terms being negotiated as part of the overall Contract negotiations
- 5.4.3 Due dates for completion of proposed system readiness
Tenderer shall provide a detailed program of System design and System Implementation. This program should clearly give a firm timetable for achievement of the relevant tasks beginning from the Contract signing date.
- 5.4.4 Detailed SLA requirements in each and every operation cycle of SLT are as follows:

SLA – Between Tenderer (XXX) and SLT

5.4.4.1 SLA - I – Performance

SLT's current bill cycles will be at 1st, 8th, 16th, 24th of every month and bill files (unformatted) will be transferred in bulk to the Tenderer XXX

However, SLT may provide bill files at any given day, other than the above four major bill cycles and printing has to be done as per expected targets below. Size of each bill file and file naming will be decided based on SLT systems and will be communicated to Tenderer XXX. Vendor shall comply to relevant SLAs in case of introducing any other bill cycle within the month.

- All non-corporate bills will be a mixture of single page/ multi page or High Revenue Bills
- Tenderer XXX to format, categorize, print, envelop and deliver the bills accordingly.
- Tenderer XXX to publish all daily finalized single page, multipage (with separate envelope types) , High Revenue bill counts under each bill batch, and made visible to SLT on line through a web application.
- Tenderer XXX shall format and print sample bills for every bill cycle and made available for SLT

Revenue and Collection Team to verify the accuracy of the bills and confirm for continuing

bulk printing.

- All non-corporate Invoices to be printed soon after the confirmation by the SLT Revenue and collection team, enveloped and handed over to Postal Department or other defined delivery channel as per the Target dates stated below (a)
- All corporate Invoices to be printed soon after the confirmation by the SLT Revenue and collection team, enveloped and handed over to Postal Department or other defined delivery channel as per the Target dates stated below (b)
- All expected completion target times will be expected to start from the time of the confirmation given by the SLT Revenue and collection team for each bill batch

(a) Non-Corporate Bills

	Number of Bills send to the vender at a time (Size of the bill batch)	Bill Type	Rate of Completion (format/print/envelope & ready to deliver)	Bill batch Completion Target	Penalty per Day per Bill
1	500,000 – 1,000,000 or more	Single page	500,000 bills per day	*Within 2 days	Rs. 1.50
2	200,000 – 499,999	Single page	500,000 bills per day	*Within 1 day	Rs. 1.50
3	20,000 – 199,999	Single page	300,000 bills per day	*Within 1 day	Rs. 1.50
4	Less than 20,000	Single page	15,000 bills per day	*Within 1 day	Rs. 1.50
5	200,000 – 400,000 or more	Multi page	200,000 bills per day	*Within 2 days	Rs. 3
6	100,000 – 199,999	Multi page	200,000 bills per day	*Within 1 day	Rs. 3
7	10,000 – 99,999	Multi page	50,000 bills per day	*Within 2 days	Rs. 3
8	1 – 10,000	Multi page	-	*Within 1 day	Rs. 3
9	1 – 10,000	Multi page High Rev bills	-	*Within 1 day	Rs. 7.50

(b) Corporate Bills (SLT will define while sending the files)

	Number of Bills sent to the vender at a time (Size of the bill batch)	Description	Completion target (Format/Print & Sort & ready to deliver)	Penalty per day per bill
1	More than 5000	Only sorting /No enveloping	Within 30 hrs.	Rs. 150/-
2	1000 – 4999	Only sorting /No enveloping	Within 24 hrs.	Rs. 150/-
3	100 – 999	Only sorting /No enveloping	Within 12 hrs.	Rs. 150/-
4	Less than 100	Only sorting /No enveloping	Within 6 hrs.	Rs. 150/-

Note: If both corporate and non-corporate bills delivered by SLT on the same day, formatting and printing priority to be done for corporate bills.

(c) E-bill (Formatted PDF)

	Number of bills send to the vendor at a time (Size of the bill batch)	Bill type	Rate of completion (Format & ready to transfer to location)	Bill batch completion target	Penalty per day per bill
1	500,000 – 1,000,000 or more	E-Bill	500,000 bills per day	*Within 2 days	10% of unit price of each delayed e-bills
2	200,000 – 499,999	E-Bill	500,000 bills per day	*Within 1 day	
3	20,000 – 199,999	E-Bill	200,000 bills per day	*Within 1 day	
4	Less than 20,000	E-Bill	20,000 bills per hour	*Within 1 day	

Note: E-bills send with an identification flag to be formatted & provided in soft form

(d) Test Bills/damaged bills

	Category of the bill	Description	Completion target (format/ Print & sort & ready to deliver)	Penalty
1	Damaged or bills with poor quality print	Any bill/ bills identified at the printing site or identified after postage to be reported to SLT and re printed	Within 48 hrs.	Printing and posting cost should be borne by vendor. If quantity

				is greater than 5% of total bills printed SLT will decide the penalty charges not more than 20% of damaged bills printing charges
2	Test bills	Test bills for existing bill formats	Immediately within one hour	
3	Test bills	Test bills for new bill formats	Depending on complexity, SLT will define delivery target dates case by case	
4	Bill image (Soft form) – on request	Special requests for formatted bills in soft form	Within one hour	

(e) Minor Changes Requested by SLT on Data formatting

Any formal request made by SLT on minor data format/print changes to be tested offline & deployed in production within maximum of three (3) days.

(f) Major Changes in data Formatting/ New Bill formats

Any formal request by SLT on a major formatting / printing change or new bill format to be tested offline & deployed in production within maximum of two (2) weeks.

5.4.4.2 SLA -II – Quality

1. The Contractor shall ensure accuracy of data while printing is in progress. Verification process must be in place to check the same & if any issue found – said bills has to be excluded & notified immediately to SLT & the rest to be continued.

Comprehensive software program to be used to check the subtotals and totals of a given bill by summation of individual charge carrying tags

2. The quality of the laser toner should be in high quality industry standard products.
3. Paper and ink quality shall be similar or better to the quality submitted with the tender.

4. Ink colors used in pre-printed advertisements/ messages / images should be maintained though out the process for all invoices in each category.
5. Quality of the glue used for sealing the envelopes should be of a high quality & industry standard.

5.4.4.3 SLA -III - Delivery of bills

(a) Delivery of paper bills

1. All the bills shall bear the postal code and shall be sorted according to the postal codes.
2. All the bills should be printed with a footer note carrying SLT original bill file names & a sequence managed by the Contractor to check the printed invoice totals & locate any damaged bills.
3. All the bills to be posted shall be handed over to Postal Department GPO office or nominated handling office with no delay.
4. All the corporate bills for hand delivery should be handed over to SLT or to a defined courier service by SLT.
5. Daily, SLT given bill file wise audit/verification report should be produced by the Contractor to SLT to reconcile the bills received and bill posted.
6. Online viewing facility of the above audit / verification reports within one hour of completing the delivery of the bill should be available for SLT.

(b) Delivery of E-Bills

1. All the soft copy bills shall be transferred to the SLT specific location categorized based on bill handling codes.
2. Soft forms of Letter of demand (LOD) shall be transferred to separate location in Print vendor server.
3. All the bills should be printed with a footer note carrying SLT original bill file names & a sequence managed by the Contractor to check the printed invoice totals & locate any damaged bills.
4. Online viewing facility of the above audit / verification reports within one hour of completing the delivery of the bill should be available for SLT

5.4.4.4 SLA -IV Data Link between SLT and the Contractor

Cost of the data link which is sufficient to handle SLT production bill data transfer between SLT & the vender production or Disaster Recovery site shall be borne by the Contractor

5.4.4.5 SLA -V- Information Security / data security

1. Physical security and data security of production sites to be maintained at industry standards throughout the contract period and until handing over or disposal of all SLT data.
2. All necessary steps to be taken to protect SLT data after being transferred to the Contractor managed network/ server locations with industry standard information security arrangements.
3. Secure connectivity to share billing and associate information with the vendor (E.g., An encrypted channel like VPN restricted to known set of Ips only).
4. Secure protocols shall be used in the printing process to avoid interception.
5. All the systems, applications and equipment used by the print vendor shall be tested for critical application vulnerabilities and necessary actions are being taken.

<https://www.boozallen.com/c/insight/blog/printer-vulnerabilities-leave-companies-at-risk.html>

6. Availability of logs in relevant systems with at least 6-month retention capabilities and backups.
7. Ensure that the vendor is certified with ISO/IEC 27001:2022 or similar applicable industry standard on security and privacy.
8. Availability of adequate document management system at the printer with access restrictions and proper storage facilities.
9. Policies to remove bill data beyond recovery in third party systems and destroy printed documents/hard copies after certain period.
10. Minimize data exposure in printing process and systems.
11. Sign Non-Disclosure Agreement with SLT and Print Vendor.
12. Mechanism to share information with SLT in case a security incident occurs.
13. Ensure physical security.

5.4.4.6 SLA- VI –Business continuity Plan at a Disaster

The Contractor to maintain a comprehensive Business Continuity Plan (BCP) at any type of disaster / site failure which effects SLT's business with following service levels.

1. Resume all business-critical processes within 24 hrs. from a catastrophic event.
2. Resume full operations at the same site or on a Disaster Recovery (DR) site within one (1) week.
3. Ensure clarity of all delivery delays within five (5) working days.
4. Performance of bill printing /delivery during the disaster recovery (DR) period will be 50 % of the above SLA-I.

5. Physical Security and Information security at the Disaster Recovery (DR) site and primary site should be with industry standard security arrangements.

5.5 Scalability of the proposed solution

The proposed bill printing solution must be scalable to accommodate SLT's evolving business needs, including additional bill cycles, personalized formats, and multilingual support. It should seamlessly integrate future technologies without disrupting existing operations, ensuring flexibility, efficiency, and enhanced customer experience across increasing volumes and diverse service requirements.

5.6 High Availability at primary site & failure over disaster Recovery sites.

High availability at the primary site ensures uninterrupted operations through redundant systems and proactive monitoring. In the event of a failure, services automatically fail over to disaster recovery (DR) sites, which maintain synchronized backups and infrastructure. This setup minimizes downtime and data loss, supporting business continuity. DR sites are strategically located and regularly tested to meet recovery time objectives (RTO) and recovery point objectives (RPO), ensuring resilience against outages, natural disasters, or cyberattacks while maintaining regulatory compliance.

5.7 Documentation

The scope of work for Sri Lanka Telecom's endend bill printing and digital distribution solution encompasses designing, developing, and delivering printed invoices and electronic bills to customers. Key deliverables include invoice generation, secure digital delivery via email and mobile platforms, and integration with existing billing systems. Tasks cover workflow automation, format validation, printing, quality control, and compliance with regulatory standards.

5.8 Data Security & Information Security

Data Security and Information Security are vital to SLT's bill printing solution, ensuring confidentiality, integrity, and availability of customer data throughout formatting, printing, and digital transfer processes. The system must implement robust encryption, access controls, and secure data handling to prevent unauthorized access or breaches. Compliance with regulatory standards and secure transmission of e-bills are essential. A web-based monitoring system should support audit trails and reporting, reinforcing SLT's commitment to protecting sensitive customer information across all operational stages